History Learning Material — The French Revolution

This material is intentionally explicit so a RAG system can be tested for evidence-based grounding. The facts below are the only facts the learning system should use when operating in learning_materials_only mode.

1. What was the French Revolution?

Definition: The French Revolution was a period of major political and social change in France that began in 1789. It challenged the existing political and social order and eventually led to the end of the French monarchy in 1792.

Key date: The Revolution began in 1789.

2. The Estates-General

In 1789, King Louis XVI called the Estates-General. It brought together representatives of the three estates of French society: the clergy, the nobility, and the Third Estate.

The Third Estate represented the common population and declared itself the National Assembly in June 1789.

3. The Storming of the Bastille

On 14 July 1789, revolutionaries in Paris stormed the Bastille, a fortress and prison. The event became an important symbol of the Revolution.

4. Declaration of the Rights of Man

In August 1789, the National Assembly adopted the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen. The document stated principles concerning liberty, equality, and political rights.

5. End of the Monarchy

In September 1792, the monarchy was abolished and France was declared a republic.

6. A simple timeline

1789: Estates-General called; National Assembly formed; Bastille stormed.
August 1789: Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen adopted.
September 1792: Monarchy abolished; France declared a republic.

Grounding Test Questions

1. What was the French Revolution?
2. When did the French Revolution begin?
3. What were the three estates represented in the Estates-General?
4. What happened on 14 July 1789?
5. What was the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen?
6. When was the French monarchy abolished according to this material?
7. What did the Third Estate declare itself in June 1789?
8. Give a short timeline of the events described in the material.